

LLM Brainstorm Activity

How I used an LLM to go from topic ideas to a defensible problem

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THE EXCHANGE

I brainstormed with Claude (Claude Code) over several sessions: first to understand the course requirements and the curated project list, then to explore topic ideas from my own interests, and finally to pressure-test the problem statement piece by piece. The full exchange is long; the excerpts submitted with this activity show the turning points, including the one where I caught and corrected the LLM's framing of the prediction window.

WHAT IT SUGGESTED

Project directions built from my interests (a flight-delay insurance model, bank distress prediction), the Prompt Corrective Action "undercapitalized" tier as an objective target label, the FDIC BankFind API as the data source, and a "within four quarters" prediction window.

WHAT I KEPT

The bank-distress early-warning idea, because it fits my broker-dealer background; the PCA-based target; the FDIC API as the primary source; and the Silicon Valley Bank framing for the executive summary.

WHAT I REJECTED AND WHY

The "within four quarters" window as first proposed: I caught that a four-quarter cumulative window can mean as little as one quarter of actual warning, so we reframed the question to "at risk, and how soon?" I also rejected Kaggle mirrors in favor of primary government sources, and rewrote the pitch and personal angle because the LLM's versions were too dramatic.